



SOARING POPULARITY:
Ayurveda is gaining acceptance
as lifestyle diseases increase

ing to develop spa products or multinationals like L'Oreal, which are now scouting for an Indian ayurveda brand. Having realised that ayurveda needs to be made more contemporary, Indian companies are working on their branding and packaging—capsules instead of syrups, pills instead of pastes—as they try and integrate their products into the everyday lives of consumers. Dabur has recently launched a sugar-free version of its blockbuster Chyawanprash, while Emami is promoting its male fairness cream, Fair and Handsome, in a big way.

However, there have been instances of ayurveda drugs containing metals that are toxic and even car-

\$120 bn
is the total global
herbal industry
while ayurveda is
a Rs 6,000 crore
domestic industry

1,54,000
metric tonne of
medicinal plants are
used in exports of
Rs 450-crore worth of
ayurveda formulations

cinogenic. Such allegations have at times forced companies to pull their medicines off the shelves and even change the original formula. With improvements in the offing, it may only be a matter of time when the ancient system of medicine weaves its magic. ■



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